

Gamescom 2026

Side events guide

Cologne, 23 to 30 August 2026 / 105 events / updated 30 July 2026

A day-by-day guide to receptions, mixers, dinners, meetups and parties taking place around gamescom in Cologne.

Times are local. Trade badge means no separate event registration but a gamescom trade pass is required. Approval means the organiser confirms attendance. Invitation-only, sold-out and not-yet-open events are labelled explicitly; their link opens the best available official detail or organiser page.

23 Aug

23 Aug
12:00-18:00

gamescom dev speaker & VIP beer garden

Badge pick-up and a warm-up for speakers and senior guests before the evening reception.

Location Wolkenburg, Mauritiussteinweg 59

Access VIP ticket or speaker; no separate registration · [Registration / details](#)

23 Aug
from 13:00

gamescom dev speaker & VIP experiences

Guided city activities for speakers and VIPs, including cathedral and Old Town experiences.

Location Across Cologne

Access VIP ticket or speaker; no separate registration · [Registration / details](#)

23 Aug
14:00-18:00

Offline Craft Club - Terrace Edition

Relaxed terrace meetup for designers and creatives.

Location ecosign Academy of Design, Vogelsanger Str. 250

Access Paid ticket, currently EUR 12.50 · [Registration / details](#)

23 Aug
17:00-22:00

Indie Hub OnSite Regulars Table

The established Cologne indie Stammtisch on the evening before gamescom dev.

Location Die Wohngemeinschaft, Richard-Wagner-Str. 39

Access Free registration · [Registration / details](#)

23 Aug
18:00-23:00

gamescom dev speaker & VIP reception

The main pre-conference evening for C-level guests, speakers and industry VIPs.

Location Wolkenburg

Access VIP, speaker or invitation only · [Registration / details](#)

23 Aug
20:00-23:00

Games [4Diversity] Showcase

Showcase and networking around diversity and inclusion in games.

Location Lost Level, Kyffhäuserstr. 39

Access Free registration · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug

24-28 Aug
Mon 09:00-Fri
15:00

MeetToMatch - The Cologne Edition 2026

Scheduled one-to-one meetings with studios, publishers, investors and service providers; powered by Xsolla.

Location Koelnmesse, Messeplatz 1

Access Paid pass · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
11:00-16:00

gamescom dev leadership summit

Closed C-level track inside the main gamescom dev programme.

Location Confex, Stage 13

Access VIP ticket or invitation only · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
15:00-17:00

FastSpring Beer & Banter

Open beer reception with no agenda; useful for quick introductions between conference sessions.

Location Confex, reception area

Access No separate registration - any gamescom dev ticket · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
16:00-19:00

In Good Company - a Gamescom Mixer

Rooftop mixer with a mixed studio, publisher and service-provider crowd.

Location rooftop58, Hohenzollernring 58

Access Free registration; organiser page may require approval · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
16:30-17:30

gamescom dev awards

Six awards covering indie expo titles, people and teams.

Location Confex, Keynote Stage

Access No separate registration - any gamescom dev ticket · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
17:00-19:00

gamescom dev speaker & VIP mixer

Drinks and networking in the gamescom dev VIP lounge.

Location Confex, VIP lounge

Access VIP ticket or speaker; no separate registration · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
17:00-21:00

Games Growth Guild

Marketing and growth leaders from indie to AAA; short programme followed by networking.

Location Rheinloft Cologne, Frankenwerft 35

Access Application; organiser approval required · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
17:00-22:00

MIX Game Showcase Cologne

Curated indie showcase with publisher, press and industry networking.

Location Design Post, Deutz-Mülheimer Str. 22A

Access Industry/press registration · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
18:00-23:00

Gamescom 1st Happy Hour

Informal exhibitor kick-off with beer and pizza; aimed at studios and publishers.

Location Südermann, Sudermanplatz 3

Access Free application; studios and publishers only · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
18:00-21:00

Reception Celebrating Women in Games

AWS, Helpshift and WIGI reception celebrating women in games.

Location Helpshift Gamescom Hub, Cologne

Access Registration / request access · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug - continued

24 Aug
18:00-23:00

GAME:IN Get Together

Community evening for FLINTA+ people and allies in games.

Location Lost Level, Kyffhäuserstr. 39

Access Waitlist / approval · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
18:00-23:00

gamescom dev leadership dinner

Closed dinner for senior industry executives.

Location The ASH Köln MesseCity

Access Invitation only - no public registration · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
18:30-23:30

Quebec Publishers Party

Evening hosted by the Québec publisher delegation.

Location Monkey Bar, Im Klapperhof 22-24

Access Free registration · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
19:00-23:00

Builder's Beach Club by Sentry & Perforce

Beach-club networking for game developers and technical teams.

Location km 689 Cologne Beach Club

Access Registration / approval · [Registration / details](#)

24 Aug
19:00-23:00

gamescom dev sunset mixer

The large open-air networking evening of gamescom dev.

Location Confex, outdoor area

Access No separate registration - any gamescom dev ticket · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug

25 Aug
11:00-17:30

Representing Games - Pitch Sessions Cologne

Twenty-five studios from Switzerland, New Zealand and Spain pitch PC and console projects.

Location Dorint Hotel am Heumarkt, Pipinstr. 1

Access Free application; publishers, investors and platforms only · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
13:00-15:00

gamescom dev CTO lunch

Closed lunch for CTOs and senior technical leaders.

Location The ASH Köln MesseCity

Access Invitation only - no public registration · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
13:00-16:00

gamescom dev pitch it! mixer

Indie teams pitch publishers, followed by open networking.

Location Confex, Foyer Süd

Access Invitation only · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
15:00-17:00

Amber beer reception

Informal reception hosted by Amber Studio.

Location Confex Expo Floor, booth D07

Access No separate registration - any gamescom dev ticket · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
15:00-17:00

Paradox PDX Community Mixer

Paradox community and partner mixer in a traditional brewhouse.

Location Brauhaus ohne Namen, Mathildenstr. 42

Access Waitlist · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
16:00-19:00

WN Connect Cologne 2026

Business networking by White Nights and WN Hub for studios, publishers and service providers.

Location SonnenscheinEtage, Galeria parking B, 14th floor

Access Request a ticket; approval required · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
16:00-20:00

Adyen x Visa - Game Plan

Roundtable and networking for games payments, monetisation and commercial leaders.

Location Sturmfreie Bude, Luxemburger Str. 124-126

Access Free registration · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
17:00-19:00

BS Beers - the Legendary Afterworks

Long-running informal afterwork with a senior games-industry crowd.

Location Venue shared with confirmed attendees

Access Free registration · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
17:00-19:00

gamescom dev VIP & business mixer

Dedicated B2B mixer with complimentary drinks.

Location Confex business area

Access No separate registration - VIP or Trade ticket · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
17:30-22:00

The Player Experience Reception

Helpshift and k-ID host senior leaders in player experience, trust and safety, community, retention and engineering.

Location Restaurant Augustin, Dagobertstr. 32

Access Invitation; request access · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug - continued

25 Aug 17:30-20:00	Accord Community Kölsch Community drinks for games-industry attendees. Location Venue to be announced Access Free registration · Registration / details
25 Aug 17:30-23:00	All In - a Night of Poker & Networking Poker tournament by GYLD and Kameha Ventures, supported by mod.io; dinner and prizes included. Location rooftop58, Hohenzollernring 58 Access Registration / approval · Registration / details
25 Aug 18:00-22:00	Pocket Gamer Mobile Games Awards 2026 Ninth edition of the awards with Samsung Gaming Hub; 23 categories and a seated dinner. Location Gürzenich Köln, Martinstr. 29-37 Access Paid ticket; limited seats · Registration / details
25 Aug 18:00-23:30	Games for Peace Mixer Free non-profit games mixer focused on peace and social impact. Location Kulturbunker Köln-Mülheim, Berliner Str. 20 Access Registration not yet published as of 30 Jul 2026 · Registration / details
25 Aug 18:00-23:00	Cyprus Nights at Cologne Reception of the Cyprus games delegation. Location Brauhaus FRÜH am Dom, Am Hof 12-18 Access Free registration · Registration / details
25 Aug 18:00-21:00	Gamescom 2026 Mixer by Singular Games-industry mixer hosted by Singular for mobile growth, marketing and product professionals. Location Heising & Adelmann, Friesenstr. 58-60 Access Registration / approval · Registration / details
25 Aug 19:00-22:00	Gamescom from Ukraine Reception Reception for Ukrainian studios, partners and supporters. Location Wolkenburg, Alexiana Room and Terrace Access Registration not yet published as of 30 Jul 2026 · Registration / details
25 Aug 19:00	PvX Private Dinner Private dinner for publishing, investment and advisory contacts. Location La Fonda Access Invitation only - no public registration · Registration / details
25 Aug 19:30-22:30	NewGen Marketing Innovators Dinner Closed dinner for marketing leadership. Location Mongo's Köln-Deutz, Ottoplatz 1 Access Free application / approval · Registration / details
25 Aug 20:00	gamescom Opening Night Live Global opening show hosted by Geoff Keighley. Location Koelnmesse and livestream Access On-site sold out; livestream free - no registration · Registration / details

25 Aug - continued

25 Aug
20:00-23:30

Courage Cologne

More than fifty developers showing playable projects; one of the largest independent side events.

Location HERBRAND's ehrenfeld, Herbrandstr. 21

Access Paid ticket · [Registration / details](#)

25 Aug
20:00-02:00

gamescom dev community night

Official gamescom dev closing party with beer garden and music.

Location HERBRAND's ehrenfeld

Access No separate registration - any dev ticket plus EUR 10 cover · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug

26 Aug
all day

Berlin-Brandenburg Reception

Regional networking reception at the joint Berlin-Brandenburg booth.

Location Hall 4.1, C063g / D078g

Access No separate registration - gamescom trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
09:00-12:00

All You Can Coffee

Morning coffee and easy first-contact networking at the SwissGames pavilion.

Location SwissGames Pavilion, Hall 4.1, B030g-C040g

Access Free registration · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
11:00-16:00

The Agent AI Summit

Half-day summit on AI agents in games.

Location Venue shared with confirmed attendees

Access Application; approval required · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
16:00-17:00

Rakija Tasting at the Serbian Booth

Serbian Games Association reception.

Location Hall 3.2, booth F030g

Access No separate registration - gamescom trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
16:00-18:00

Sumo Mixer

Open booth mixer hosted by Sumo.

Location Hall 2.1, aisle D-017 / C-018

Access No separate registration - gamescom trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
16:00-19:00

UGC Gaming Mixer

Networking for user-generated-content studios, platforms and partners.

Location Früh am Dom, Am Hof 12-18

Access Registration · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
16:00-20:00

Dexerto Gamescom Happy Hour

Media, creator, marketing and commercial networking.

Location Dorint Hotel An der Messe, Deutz-Mülheimer Str. 22-24

Access Registration / approval · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
16:30-17:30

Spain Happy Hour

Spanish pavilion drinks and delegation networking.

Location Hall 4.1, C050g / B041g

Access No separate registration - gamescom trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
17:00-18:00

Netherlands Pavilion Happy Hour

Dutch Games Association pavilion reception.

Location Hall 4.1, A021g-B030g

Access No separate registration - gamescom trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
17:00-23:00

XR Get-Together

Networking for XR and immersive-technology professionals.

Location Venue to be announced

Access Registration not yet published as of 30 Jul 2026 · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug - continued

26 Aug 17:30-23:00	Mobidictum Mixer Cologne Executive mobile-games mixer sponsored by Exmox and Famobi. Location Pe 303 Rhein Location, Im Zollhafen 15-17 Access Application; approval required · Registration / details
26 Aug 17:30-04:00	ASUS ROG Party Large hardware-brand party. Location E-Werk, Schanzenstr. 37 Access Guest list only - no public registration · Registration / details
26 Aug 18:00-21:00	GameDistribution - Casual Gaming Community Dinner Invitation-only riverside dinner for GameDistribution partners and the casual-games community. Location Restaurant maiBeck, Am Frankenturm 5 Access Invitation only; RSVP deadline 26 Jul has passed · Registration / details
26 Aug 18:00-21:00	The #MarketersInGaming Meet-up Games-marketing meetup hosted by 1minus1; donations to SpecialEffect welcome. Location The Copper Pot, Bolzengasse 7 Access Free registration · Registration / details
26 Aug 18:00-22:00	Gateway to Asia at Köln Seminars and mixer focused on the Asian market, presented by Gamirror Games and Shochiku Games. Location Maritim Hotel, Heumarkt 20 Access RSVP; capacity limited · Registration / details
26 Aug 18:00-00:00	Hivemind World Games Mixer Founders, executives, publishers and investors with roundtables and curated speed networking. Location Cologne; venue shared on approval Access Invitation / waitlist · Registration / details
26-30 Aug from 18:00	Bar Citizen Open Star Citizen community bar running throughout the show. Location Brauhaus ohne Namen, Mathildenstr. 42 Access Open entry - no registration required · Registration / details
26 Aug 19:00-22:00	Anybrain Supper Club Small dinner around anti-cheat, player behaviour and online safety. Location Great Wall Restaurant, Komödienstr. 37 Access Registration / approval · Registration / details
26 Aug 19:00-00:00	Maraoke LIVE! Karaoke night with video-game jokes. Location TURISTARAMA, Mauritiussteinweg 102 Access Paid ticket, general admission EUR 18 · Registration / details
26 Aug 19:30-22:30	Helpshift's Hideaway VIP Dinner Invitation-only customer dinner; arrivals at 19:30 and first course at 20:00. Location Maison Blue, Im Ferkulum 18-22 Access Invitation; request access · Registration / details

26 Aug - continued

26 Aug
19:30-23:30

Pocket Gamer 20th Anniversary Party

Anniversary edition of the established Pocket Gamer industry party.

Location Klub Domhof, Hohenzollernbrücke 11

Access Free for verified industry professionals; work email required · [Registration / details](#)

26 Aug
20:00-23:00

Xbox FanFest

Xbox 25th-anniversary fan event.

Location Hall 7.1, Xbox booth

Access Registration / sweepstakes entry · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug

27 Aug
09:00-10:00

Morning Reset

Early movement and informal networking session by the Rhine.

Location Kennedy-Ufer 2a

Access Free registration · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
all day

gamescom congress

Conference on the social, cultural and economic impact of games.

Location Koelnmesse

Access Separate paid ticket · [Registration / details](#)

27-29 Aug
Thu 11:00-Sat
19:00

Worlds of Play - The Game Art Exhibition

Three-day game-art exhibition presented by Tencent.

Location Wassermannhalle, Girlitzweg 30

Access Ticket / timed entry · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
13:00-14:30

Catalan Mixer

Catalan delegation mixer.

Location Hall 4.1, B050 / A041

Access RSVP plus gamescom trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
16:00-17:00

Spain Happy Hour

Spanish pavilion reception.

Location Hall 4.1, C050g / B041g

Access No separate registration - gamescom trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
16:00-17:00

Hessen-Empfang

Reception of the German state of Hesse, with regional studios and agencies.

Location Hall 4.1, D060

Access No separate registration - gamescom trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
16:00-18:00

Drinks at Games From Portugal Pavilion

Portuguese delegation and ecosystem networking.

Location Hall 4.1, C-020g

Access Free registration plus trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
16:30-18:00

Overwolf Happy Hour

Creator, UGC and in-game monetisation networking at the Overwolf booth.

Location Koelnmesse business area

Access Free registration · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
17:00-18:00

Netherlands Pavilion Happy Hour

Dutch pavilion reception.

Location Hall 4.1, A021g-B030g

Access No separate registration - gamescom trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
17:00-18:30

Game x Science Meet-up

Research-and-industry crossover meetup.

Location Hall 4.1, Germany booth B-056g / C064g

Access Advance registration plus trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug - continued

27 Aug
17:00-19:00

Meet the Icelandic Gaming Industry

Icelandic games delegation reception.

Location ANNO 1858, Heumarkt 6

Access Free registration · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
17:00-19:30

Enchant Gaming Pitch Party

Pitch session followed by networking.

Location VAPIANO Köln Mediapark, Im Mediapark 1

Access Registration · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
18:00-20:00

Playing for the Planet Drinks Mixer

Sustainability-alliance mixer.

Location Koelnmesse Hall 3, Ottoplatz 7

Access Registration plus gamescom access · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
18:00-22:00

Gray Zone Warfare Meetup

Community meetup hosted around Gray Zone Warfare.

Location Sticky Fingers, Kennedy-Ufer 2a

Access Registration link is distributed by organiser; see event guide · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
19:00-23:00

Above Cologne - Gamescom Networking Night

Curated C-level rooftop evening hosted by ROKKY and KLEOS; flying buffet.

Location Osman 30, Im Mediapark 8

Access Application; approval required · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
19:00-23:30

ZOTAC 20 Years Anniversary Night

Hardware-brand anniversary night.

Location Goldfinger Club, Friesenstr. 54

Access Guest list by organiser email - no public registration · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
19:30-23:30

Enchant After Gaming Party

Afterparty following the Enchant pitch session.

Location VAPIANO Köln Mediapark

Access Registration · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
20:00-22:30

JiggyTones - Gaming Music Live

Live game-music concert featuring David Wise.

Location MTC Cologne, Zülpicher Str. 10

Access Paid ticket · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
20:00-23:30

CD PROJEKT RED Community Party DACH

Studio community party for the DACH region.

Location Venue to be announced

Access Registration closed - deadline was 29 Jul 2026 · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug
20:00-02:00

ANIME SOUNDS by CrispyRob

Large anime-music party.

Location Bootshaus, Auenweg 173

Access Paid ticket · [Registration / details](#)

27 Aug - continued

27 Aug
22:00-03:00

Vex After Dark

Late-night techno programme.

Location Klub Domhof, Hohenzollernbrücke 11

Access Paid ticket · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug

28 Aug
13:00-14:30

Game Audio Lunch Party

Lunch format for audio directors, composers and studios.

Location Hall 3.2, B030g / C031g

Access Free registration plus trade badge · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug
18:00-23:30

Remedy Community Event

Community event hosted around Remedy Entertainment.

Location Venue to be announced

Access Registration not yet published as of 30 Jul 2026 · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug
19:00-00:00

Wargaming Community Party

Large Wargaming community party.

Location HERBRAND's ehrenfeld, Herbrandstr. 21

Access Sold out · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug
19:00-23:00

Community MeetUp powered by Twitch

Creator and streamer meetup with an AFK zone.

Location Moxy Cologne Mülheim, Am Kabellager 15

Access Registration · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug
19:00-23:30

Gamescom Afterparty by TaKeTV

Community afterparty at TaKe's Gaming Bar; note that the venue is in Krefeld.

Location TaKe's Gaming Bar, Alte Linner Str. 93-97, Krefeld

Access Registration · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug
19:00-23:59

GAMING meets JU

Politics and gaming community evening.

Location HEJ LOVE Eventloft, Große Brinkgasse 2b

Access Registration · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug
19:00-04:00

Beanscom Dosenbeatz 2026

Large community music night by Rocket Beans.

Location DIE HALLE Tor 2, Girlitzweg 30

Access Paid ticket · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug
19:30-22:30

Game Audio Get Together

Main audio-professional gathering of the week.

Location Salzgasse 2

Access Registration · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug
20:00-23:30

Gaming trifft Buch

Games-and-literature reading evening.

Location Thalia Mayersche, Neumarkt 2

Access Sold out · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug
22:00-04:00

C'MON with Rewi, Sarazar & Friends

Creator-led club night.

Location Bootshaus, Auenweg 173

Access Paid ticket · [Registration / details](#)

28 Aug - continued

28 Aug
22:30-05:00

K-Pop Party - Gamescom Afterparty

Late public afterparty.

Location Electrum Club, Rolshover Str. 384

Access Paid ticket · [Registration / details](#)

29-30 Aug

29 Aug
13:00-21:00

Echo RWF Watch Party - Venomous Abyss

Esports watch party at SK Gaming.

Location SK Gaming, Eupener Str. 67

Access Registration · [Registration / details](#)

29 Aug
18:00-23:30

The PUBG Outpost

KRAFTON community activation.

Location Club Bahnhof Ehrenfeld, Bartholomäus-Schink-Str. 65

Access Registration via organiser · [Registration / details](#)

29-30 Aug
Sat 22:00-Sun
03:00

Otaku Party - Anime Party Gamescom Edition

Anime party closing the week.

Location die kunstbar, Chargesheimerplatz 1

Access Paid ticket · [Registration / details](#)

29-30 Aug
Sat and Sun

gamescom city festival 2026

Free open-air festival with artists, DJ sets, activities and street food; 2026 line-up not yet announced.

Location Hohenzollernring and Rudolfplatz

Access Open entry - no registration required · [Registration / details](#)

Multi-day & TBA

gamescom week
07:30; date TBA

Games Industry Runners - Gamescom Edition

Sunrise industry run hosted by Kohort and Newzoo, conversational pace with refreshments afterwards.

Location Paolozzibrunnen; route along the Rhine

Access Registration / approval · [Registration / details](#)

gamescom week
date/time TBA

MSI BBQ Event

MSI product news and BBQ networking during gamescom week.

Location The New Yorker HARBOUR.CLUB

Access Registration not yet published as of 30 Jul 2026 · [Registration / details](#)

28-30 Aug
programme
varies

Games Done Quick - European Premiere

GDQ's European debut with three days of charity speedrunning inside gamescom.

Location Koelnmesse

Access No separate side-event registration - gamescom ticket required · [Registration / details](#)

24-31 Aug
continuous

gamescom camp

Gamescom campsite within walking distance of Koelnmesse.

Location Youth hostel and campsite by the Rhine

Access Paid accommodation booking · [Registration / details](#)